



# Six seconds.

STORIES FROM THE BOATS AND THE FACTORY FLOOR

FISHERMEN, ENGINEERS, AND THE SIX SECONDS BETWEEN THE WATER AND THE RECORD. A FIELD BRIEF BY DAVID T PHUNG.

*Shinkei*  
SYSTEMS

SEPT 2026

DAVIDTPHUNG.COM  
PREPARED FOR SHINKEI

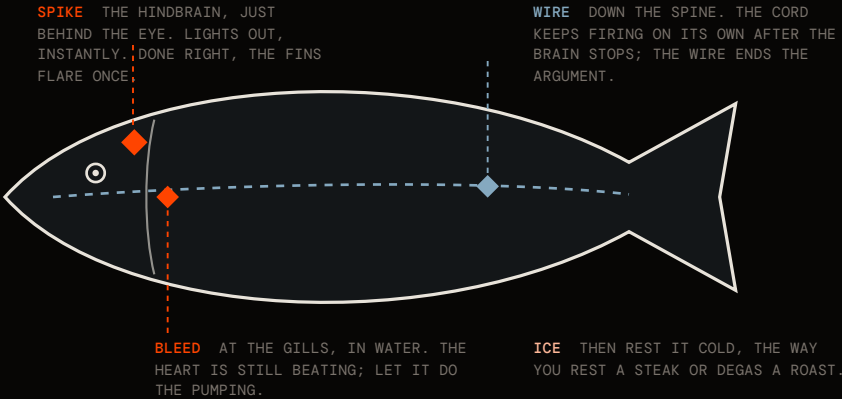
NO. 01

A FIELD GUIDE, POURED LIKE YOUR COFFEE CARD

First, learn  
the word.

活け締め

**IKEJIME.** IKE: ALIVE. JIME: TO CLOSE.  
THE TRADE SHORTHAND USES ONE STROKE: 活けズ.  
SAY IT: EE-KEH-JEE-MEH.



| THE CARD      |                                           |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------|
| METHOD        | Ikejime 活け締め, then a cold rest            |
| DOSE          | One fish, whole. No substitutions.        |
| TIME          | ~6.0 s by machine; minutes by hand        |
| TOOLS         | Spike, wire, seawater, ice. Or one robot. |
| YIELD         | Two extra weeks, worth spending well      |
| TASTING NOTES | Sweet, dense, clear. Nothing to hide      |

SKIPPED / SOUR, THEN ROT

IKEJIME / UMAMI, SLOWLY



AFTER “WHAT IS IKEJIME 活け締め”, LA PETIT NOISSETTE, 2019 · THE MACHINE THAT DOES ALL FOUR IS ON PAGE 6

01 / THE ENGINEERS

Surgery, at sea,  
in six seconds.

The problem sounds simple until you stand on the deck. Find the hindbrain of a living fish, a target a few millimeters wide that sits somewhere different in every species and every individual, and reach it in one instant action, while the boat pitches, the spray corrodes everything it touches, and the next fish is already coming aboard.

Reed Ginsberg, Shinkei’s cofounder and CTO, compares the environment to aerospace and calls it worse. Salt water beats vacuum for cruelty to hardware.

So the team in El Segundo builds like a field crew, not a lab. Poseidon units come off the line in parallel, ship in weeks, and get repaired where they bolt down. Vision finds the target. The machine does the rest in about six seconds, then writes what it did to a record that follows the fish to the plate.

The craft they automated took ike jime masters years to learn. The craft they practice, machines that do delicate work in brutal places, takes just as long. It tastes like the difference.

|                                   |                                     |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ENVIRONMENT                       | HARDWARE CADENCE                    |
| Salt spray                        | Weeks                               |
| “WORSE THAN AEROSPACE” – GINSBERG | UNITS BUILT IN PARALLEL, EL SEGUNDO |

“We’re basically doing the equivalent of surgery on these fish.”

SAIF KHAWAJA, FOUNDER AND CEO, TO FAST COMPANY, 2026





# The boat is the product.

BILL / MORRO BAY, CA

On the water since the winter of 1975. His first boat came at nineteen. He says the hardest thing about fishing is that your life is not your own: two thirds of every year is spent at sea, and a razor thin margin decides whether the year worked. He remembers every fish he has processed.

JAY / ILWACO, WA

Started fishing as a kid. What keeps him coming back is the camaraderie, and the belief that people should eat fresh caught American fish. Keeping fish local, he says, is the single biggest thing that supports the fleet. The premium Shinkei pays lands on boats like his first.

NICK / MARTHA'S VINEYARD, MA

Takes pride in what comes off his boat and where it goes next. With Poseidon aboard, a catch that once had five days now has two weeks, which means a different buyer at a different price. He hopes to fish to the very end, maybe one day as deckhand on his son's boat.

*"I feed people."  
"This is just like evolution of  
fishing at its finest."*

SEREMONI, **EVERY CATCH HAS A STORY**, 2026. NONE OF THEM TALK ABOUT ROBOTS. THEY TALK ABOUT MARKETS.

WATCH THE FILM: [YOUTUBE](#) / [EVERY CATCH HAS A STORY](#)

PHOTO: MATT & ALEX LOWBER / LOBO FOR FAST COMPANY. COOK INLET, ALASKA, 2026.

ONE CYCLE, DRAWN TO SCALE: A TICK IS A QUARTER SECOND

Six seconds, on the clock.

活け締め

IKEJIME / TIGHTENED WHILE STILL ALIVE. A CENTURIES OLD CRAFT, NOW DONE BY A MACHINE THAT NEVER GETS TIRED AND NEVER GETS IT WRONG.



SHINKEI, MEASURED

SHELF LIFE, CONVENTIONAL 5-7 days

SHELF LIFE, POSEIDON 2-3 weeks

REACHES A PLATE AT QUALITY 93%

INDUSTRY AVERAGE ~ one third

CYCLE TIME, AT SEA ~6.0 s

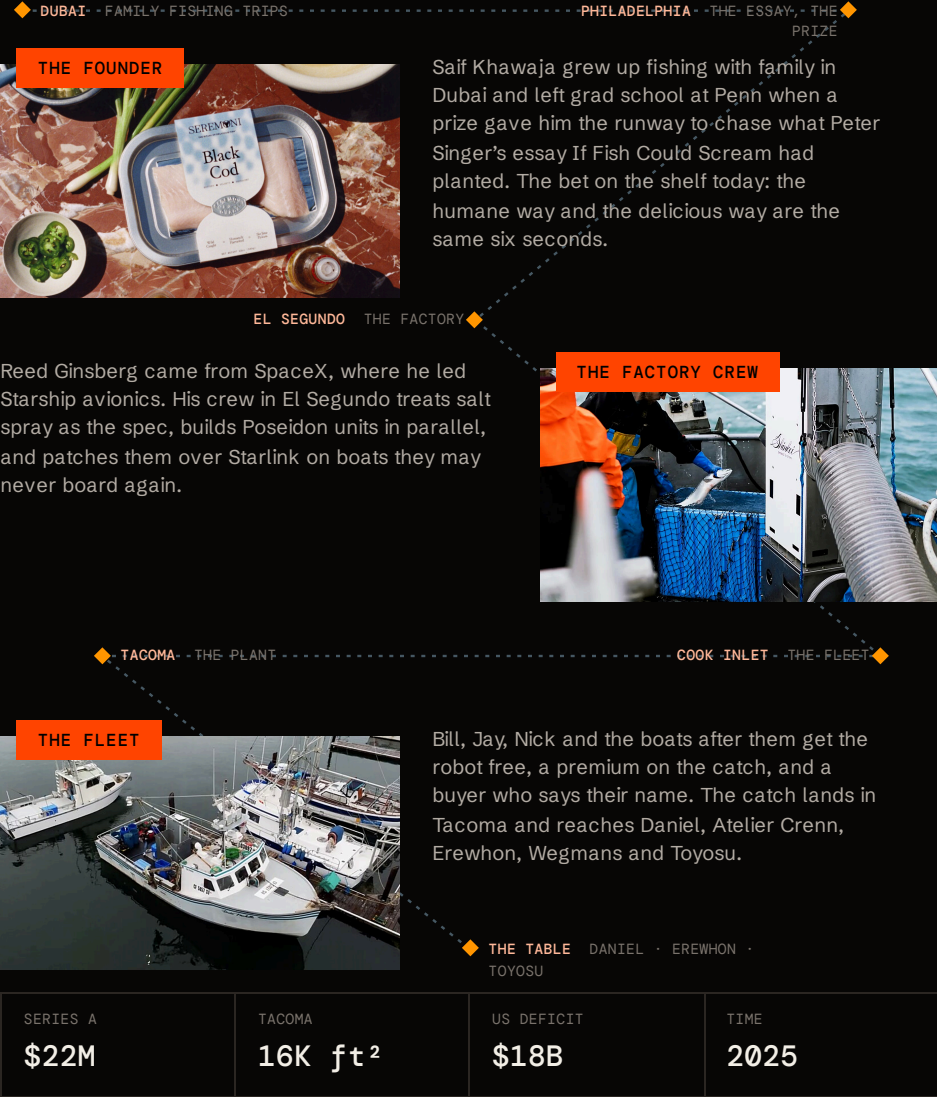
SPECIES IN THE MODEL 50 scanned

SENSOR PROGRAM NERA PROJECTS A QUALITY WINDOW PER FISH, THE WAY A BUYER READS A BANANA.

SOURCES: SHINKEI.SYSTEMS; FAST COMPANY, JULY 2026; TECHCRUNCH, JUNE 2026.

THE PEOPLE BEHIND THE RECORD, JOINED BY ONE ROUTE

Two crews. One promise.



Brief by David T Phung. I would rather show you than tell you, so I built this.





# Stress has a flavor.

**So does its absence.** A fish that fights floods its own muscle with the chemistry of panic. The flesh burns through its energy, turns acidic, goes soft, and starts aging the moment it hits the deck. You have eaten that fish. Everyone has.

A fish that never knows the fight keeps everything the panic spends: the sweetness, the density, the two weeks of patience. Seremoni fish are line caught or trap caught, never netted, never left on a deck. The founder learned the difference the hard way, working as a commercial deckhand.

IKE JIME, FINISHED BEFORE FEAR BEGINS

*Six seconds of engineering,  
so dinner can take three hours.*



**Every pack is a program note.** Species, boat, water, harvest date, and the name of the person who caught it. Not because provenance is fashionable, but because a fish handled this carefully has nothing to hide and a story worth saying grace over.

Cook it simply. Salt, heat, restraint. The work was done at sea; your job is to not undo it.

KEEPS AT QUALITY

**2-3 wks**

CONVENTIONAL: 5-7 DAYS

HANDLED BY

**1 machine**

ZERO PANIC, ZERO GUESSWORK

## ON THE MENU

Daniel. Atomix. Eleven Madison Park. Atelier Crenn. Bar Miller. YESS. And, because ceremony should not require a reservation, Erewhon and Wegmans. The house mission, quoted because four words cannot be improved: "Michelin quality fish for all."

A TASTING MENU FISH AT A TUESDAY PRICE

PHOTOS: SEREMONI. SOURCE: SEREMONI.COM/ABOUT-US. THE SPREAD OVERLEAF MAPS EVERY STOP FROM THE WATER TO YOUR TABLE, WITH A CODE THAT FINDS THE NEAREST ONE.

*Shinkei*

The map is  
the menu.

EVERY STOP THE RECORD TOUCHES

|                         |                                                        |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| COOK INLET, AK          | THE FLEET. 7 BOATS, POSEIDON ON DECK.                  |
| ILWACO / MORRO BAY / MV | JAY, BILL AND NICK’S BOATS, THREE COASTS.              |
| TACOMA, WA              | THE PLANT. 16,000 SQ FT; THE RECORD FOLLOWS THE FISH.  |
| EL SEGUNDO, CA          | HQ AND FACTORY. UNITS BUILT IN PARALLEL.               |
| NEW YORK, NY            | DANIEL, ATOMIX, ELEVEN MADISON PARK, BAR MILLER, YESS. |
| SF / LA / EAST          | ATELIER CRENN, EREWHON, WEGMANS ROLLING OUT.           |
| TOKYO                   | TOYOSU MARKET, WHERE THE STANDARD WAS SET.             |



SCAN FOR THE NEAREST TABLE

The store locator answers the only question this page leaves open: how far are you, right now, from a fish that was treated better than most produce?

ONE FISH, FOUR LAYERS: THE CATCH, THE MACHINE THAT CALMS IT, THE PEOPLE IT PAYS, AND THE COUNTRY IT FEEDS. LAYER GRAPHIC BY SHINKEI SYSTEMS, FROM SHINKEI.SYSTEMS. SOURCES: SEREMONI.COM; PRESS, 2025 TO 2026.



AMERICAN  
FISH

AMERICAN  
MACHINES

AMERICAN  
FISHERMEN

AMERICAN  
OPERATION





SEREMONI GRADE · THE CONSUMER FACING ARM OF SHINKEI · 活け締め · GRADE A

**WILD CAUGHT**  
AMERICAN FISHERMEN,  
AMERICAN WATERS

**NOTHING ADDED**  
NO PRESERVATIVES, NO  
CHEMICALS

**HUMANE**  
HANDS FREE IKE JIME, IN  
SECONDS

**KEEPS**  
EXTENDED SHELF LIFE,  
NEVER FROZEN

JOIN THE TEAM



*Shinkei*  
**SYSTEMS**

A FIELD BRIEF FOR **SHINKEI SYSTEMS** BY **DAVID T PHUNG**  
DAVIDTPHUNG.COM / DAVIDTPHUNG@NLT143.ENERGY / LOS ANGELES  
NOT AFFILIATED WITH SHINKEI SYSTEMS OR SEREMONI

SOURCES: SHINKEI.SYSTEMS · SEREMONI.COM · TIME BEST INVENTIONS 2025 · FAST COMPANY 07.22.26 ·  
TECHCRUNCH 06.20.26 · SEREMONI, EVERY CATCH HAS A STORY. PHOTOS: LOBO FOR FAST COMPANY; SHINKEI  
SYSTEMS; SEREMONI. ALL BELONG TO THEIR OWNERS. NON COMMERCIAL BRIEF.